

# Gaming Hardware: Put Your Game Face On

The idea of gaming stopped being something for children a long time ago. PC and console games today are highly advanced in all respects, be it the storyline, content, graphics or the kind of hardware they use. That said, playing the newest games requires one to be equipped with top-of-the-line hardware, starting from gaming consoles to keyboards and mice. It is a huge market not only in India but all over the world, and here's what it has to offer



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**G**aming hardware covers a wide array of items that gamers like to use to make their experience exhilarating. While the most common are gaming consoles, graphics cards and headsets, there is a lot more to it. Contrary to what many think, hardcore gamers still consider the PC to be the king of gaming. While consoles like Sony Playstation and Microsoft Xbox have for long gained immense popularity in the market, it's hard to overlook the raw power of top-of-the-line graphics cards like those sold by AMD and other giants in this segment.

Let us look at what all a gamer buys. Even though it isn't the undisputed winner, a gaming console is still an important piece of gaming equipment. Then there are graphics cards, headphones, mice and other things.

## Gaming consoles

With open source giant Valve's Steam Machines close to making an appearance, the console arena is now more interesting than ever. While the battle

has for long been between Sony Playstation (PS) and Microsoft Xbox, the Steam Machine threatens both of these in a way that has never been done before. The other option is the Nintendo Wii, which is more of a motion-driven gaming option.

The rule of thumb in this segment is to buy the newest version available in the market. But there is a small window after the launch of a new console, when you can still buy the older model. For example, both Microsoft and Sony launched their Xbox One and Playstation 4 consoles around October last year. So the window to buy the PS3 and Xbox 360 is just about over now. It takes some time for a new console to pick up speed and become the platform of choice for game makers, which is when you can buy the older version. But if you intend to buy a PS2 now, it would be a mistake, to say the least.

Also available in this segment are handheld gaming consoles. These, in our opinion, make more sense for less serious gamers. If you do not go past the 'easy' difficulty level on a game, but like to play it till the very end, you should get one of these. You can play your games on the go and it doubles up as a tool for listening to music and as a portable storage device as well.

## Laptops

When we say that PC is still the king of gaming, it includes the important position held by gaming laptops. A lot of gamers like to buy gaming laptops

instead of assembling an entire PC unit. The portability factor plays a huge role in this. The leading name in this segment would be Alienware from Dell, but there are also other offerings from Asus etc.

Gaming laptops though are quite costly, with price tags of ₹ 100,000 and above. The units sold by Asus are somewhat cheaper as compared to Alienware, but Alienware has for long been the name in the gaming segment. If you are buying a gaming laptop, get ready to spend a bomb, because these are top-of-the-line devices that exude raw power to give you the best gaming experience.

On the other hand, a recreational yet serious gamer (like those who spent money on every new game, but spend just enough time to finish the game in the easy mode) could also go for a top-of-the-line laptop like the Dell XPS series. These aren't meant for gaming, but they are powerful enough to play many of the best games.

## Graphics cards

Here we enter the realm of hardcore gamers. A high-end graphics card that can support almost any game isn't available for chump change. The nVidia GeForce GTX series, for example, can cost ₹ 20,000 and more. To put it in perspective, you can assemble a low-end PC for a little more than that.

A serious and true gamer will not compromise on this bit of hardware and will spend lots on it. So, whether you choose a graphics card from nVidia, AMD or anyone else, get ready to spend some big bucks on this. What you are looking for is something that suits the kind of games you like to play